I finished my protein-structure course that month but decided I didn't like lecturing that much—not when it meant I taught both semesters, with the student nurses thrown in. And I had to do more with the student nurses than with the laboratory portion of the course. Walker was supposed to do the lecture but he was frequently unable to come in. He had abandoned his city home and moved out to his wife's family farm since his father-in-law was too old to live there by himself. It meant a long commuting distance of forty miles, and in bad weather he was reluctant to try. Sometimes, even in good weather, problems kept him at home. One time, a horse was sick—and when he didn't come in, I had to give a lecture on some subject on short notice.

Then, too, Marty Greenberg sent me a statement (at last) that carefully worked out my total earnings, over and above what small sums I had been paid, at no more than $950. This seemed low to me,- con-

sidering that it covered four books, but unless I had an accountant go over Marty's ledgers there was nothing to do but take his word for it.

What's more, he only sent me the figures; not a check. He might have felt that sending both figures and a check might have induced a heart attack in me, and he was far too concerned about my health to risk that.

Oh well, the February 1954 F &> SF contained 'The Fun They Had," which now appeared for the first time before a science-fiction audience. The February 1954 Astounding included the first part of "Sucker Bait," 10 which Campbell had converted into a two-part serial, the fourth serial I had had in Astounding. The first part got the cover.

"The Singing Bell" was rejected by Argosy, its fourth rejection, and with a printed rejection slip, yet. It was a humbling experience.

However, January did see advance copies of The Caves of Steel in book form arrive, and this was the book that, up to that time, I felt most satisfied with. And on February 2, Fred Pohl accepted "It's Such a Beautiful Day" for an anthology of original stories he was doing for Ballantine.

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On February 6, 1954, I finished "The End of Eternity." It was about 25,000 words long and I was very pleased with it. I sent it off to Horace, and on the ninth he called me. It was a complete rejection. He talked revision but what he wanted was a complete revision. It would have amounted to jacking up the title and running a new story under it. I refused point-blank to do this, and that